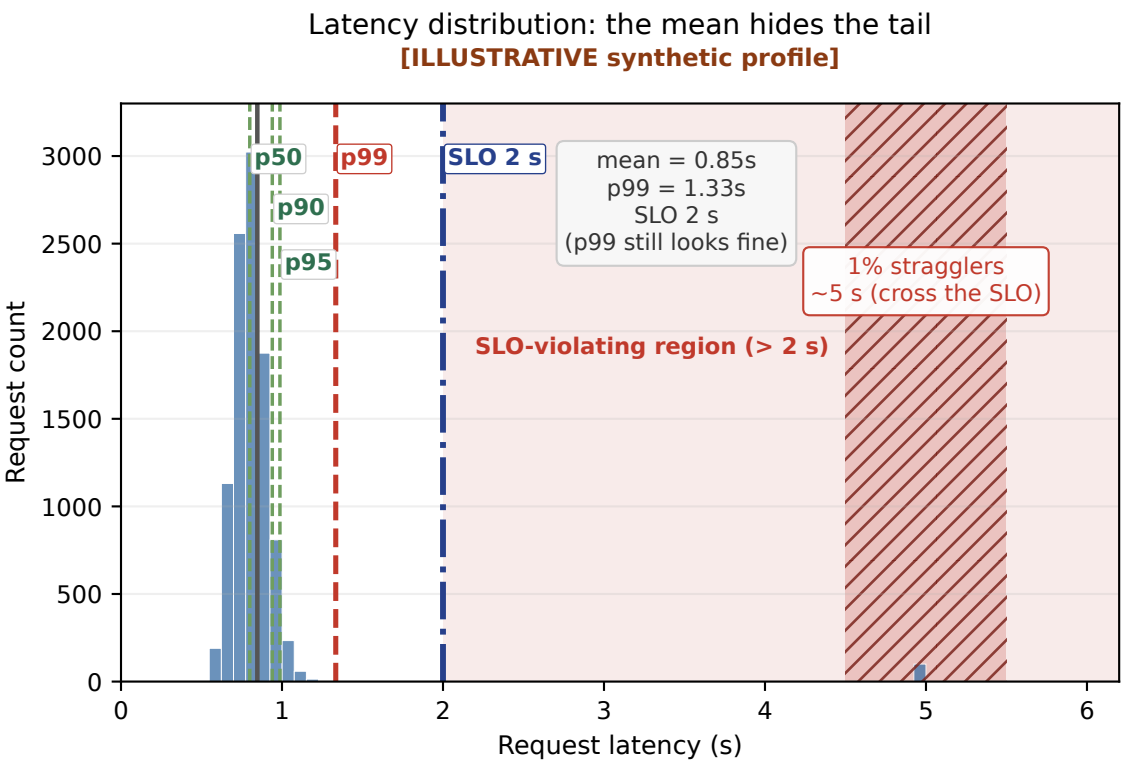
Latency distribution: the mean hides the tail
[ILLUSTRATIVE synthetic profile]
p50
p90
p95
p99
SLO 2 s
mean = 0.85s
p99 = 1.33s
SLO 2 s
(p99 still looks fine)
1% stragglers
~5 s (cross the SLO)
SLO-violating region (> 2 s)
Request count
Request latency (s)
0
500
1000
1500
2000
2500
3000
0
1
2
3
4
5
6